The Wheel Still Turning

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 5, Episode 10

Water turned the wheel. The chime arm rested in a catch. Nib watched both, then carefully reported that one moving part was moving while another was not. Lark welcomed the smaller, clearer observation. The mechanism could be understood one relationship at a time.

“It is all turning, except the bit that is not,” Nib reported carefully. “That difference matters,” Lark replied.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **jumped**

“Ing can describe an ongoing action in planting, jumping, and resting,” Lark modeled clearly. “Here the base stays visible before ing. Compare planted with planting. Later words may need spelling changes; today we use examples whose base stays intact.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try planting, jumping, resting. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read the ongoing and completed descriptions,” Lark invited gently. “Which one matches the wheel now, and which matches yesterday's screen work?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The wheel is turning. The arm is resting.**

“Which part is resting?” Lark asked gently. “Does the passage say every part has stopped?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The comparison separated current motion from finished repair. Lark followed the guide's linkage line from the waiting arm to a small reset lever. The arm was being held, not waiting for the water to begin. They left the flowing channel alone and prepared to inspect that helper control with the keeper.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write resting beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal showed two simultaneous states. Nib traced the linkage on paper rather than poking at the mechanism. The next test would use the lever that actually did the reset job.